

SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS



Stacker News Live walked so
that **Stacker Sports** could run



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propaganda here*

SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS



Bitchill 🌴 s02 @ Prospera, Roatan, Honduras /// Jan 18-28

4639 sats \ 10k boost \ 5 comments \ @itsTomekK 7 Dec events

After a successful s01 of our week long retreat/unconference on Roatan, we decided to organize... another one, this January.

I live in a free city Próspera on Roatan, where with Amity Age we build bitcoin ecosystem... and organize retreats for Bitcoiners who want to visit. Workshops, barbecues, relax, diving, tourism, sports, quality networking... in one of the best formats for bitcoin event one can imagine. Worth it.

There is also Satlantis Nostr event, if you don't like Luma!



January 18-28
Roatan, Honduras

Wanna fly in this January or some other day?
Leave a comment!
#Bitchill comes right before PlanB Salvador,
so you could plan a nice Centralamerican trip.

 DRAFT OF AGENDA.

 BITCOIN DISTRICT PAGE



note from the editor

I visited the park and planted myself under a tree.
I spoke aloud the undone tasks, the pile of problems I have
to sort out. Sort of like a meditation, I hoped that speaking
them could release me from their bind for a time. And then I
wrote a poem. It wasn't a good one, but I'll reproduce a
piece of it for you:

*It is not the season of action, no.
Time to sink into, sink into winter.
blankets coffee cups books familiarity -
emerge with a story.*

created by @plebpoet

supported by @k00b



Bitcoin is complex; people are busy

4920 sats \ 25 comments \ @billytheked
6 Dec mostly_harmless

**I tend to feel there are three kinds of bitcoiners
-- and each of them occupies a "niche of a niche."**

- i. the technically-minded
- ii. the economically-minded
- iii. the speculative investors (aka fiat/ngu maxis)[1]

It seems to me that people who don't comfortably sit in one of these three categories are just too preoccupied with fiat life to be bothered.

The daily grind seems to wear people down more and more every year. They have less mental bandwidth -- let alone unallocated capital -- to spend the time learning and investing in bitcoin. I'm saying this with the experience of having tried to sell the idea of bitcoin to many otherwise sensible people. I suspect, while they may not have been forthcoming about this, that each of them is just too preoccupied to care (none of them would identify as being any of the first three things on the list either.)

They are just average people with may too much on their plate to care about learning about bitcoin.

And then you have bitcoiners/podcasters shouting from the rooftops, ad nauseum, lower your time preference, *limited supply*, *hard money*, *self-sovereignty*, etc. Of course, I'd agree, all these things are important, but they are probably a far cry from the concerns of the individuals (an increasing majority of people, it seems) living hand to mouth. The best one is when they say, "bitcoin is the escape hatch." Sure it is. And so is this:



Bitcoin is:

1. a great way for developers/programmers to get paid
2. for many reasons, interesting from an economic perspective
3. historically, a high-performing asset
4. a potentially great savings vehicle, which is the only aspect that would have any importance to those to whom I have tried to sell the idea of bitcoin, so called "plebs." None of them is a programmer, interested in economics nor is he/she that concerned with stonks/assets/equities.

All of them are great friends of mine who I get to see increasingly less because we are all increasingly busy with the increasing demands of (fiat) life.

I think there is a paradox here that puts a fly in the ointment of mass adoption: the more money printed, the more life sucks for most people, the less time/resources/energy they have to learn about bitcoin.

Change my mined.

1. iv. the plebs -- which I didn't really count because I think what is conventionally referred to as a pleb is a cross-section of all three.

one
notable
comment

there are more comments you can read here:



111 sats \ 0 replies \ @Scoresby 6 Dec

I really like this way of thinking about adoption: the quotidian fiddly-ness of life gets in the way of more important things -- maybe can be called "fiat" or maybe it's just that human nature that we are very easily caught up in grooming the monkey in front of us or daydreaming at the forest leaves above rather than ascending into galaxy-brained super monkeys. Maybe one thing that is missing is fear. My experience with talking to normies about bitcoin has been that people are afraid of it: afraid it is a scam, afraid to hold much of their wealth in it, afraid that it is illegal or "for criminals," or just afraid of it because it's foreign. When you add the discomfort caused by this fear to all the rest, it is much easier for a person to keep on watching the latest tv series or shopping for bow ties. It doesn't feel good to venture into the unknown. Maybe most people don't want to be explorers.

RIP #10: What makes a good post?



+Long form content is increasing on SN

3934 sats \ 9 comments \ @SimpleStacker 6 Dec econ

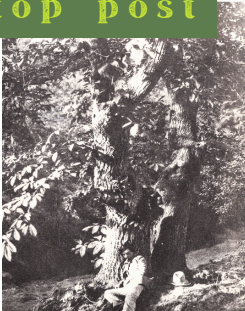
top post

top post

top post

Research in Public #10: What makes a good post? +Long form content is increasing on SN[1]

Just a quick update on some interesting results. I earlier posted about the determinants of post quality, but the model was pretty opaque. Here is a table distilling the essence of that in an easier to understand form:



		Number of words		
		None	1-50	>50
Is link post	No images or links	$\bar{z} = 166$	$\bar{z} = 214$	$\bar{z} = 250$
		$\bar{c} = 1.2$	$\bar{c} = 2.4$	$\bar{c} = 2.7$
	Has images or links	$N = 91,721$	$N = 10,392$	$N = 10,486$
			$\bar{z} = 202$	$\bar{z} = 513$
Not link post	No images or links		$\bar{c} = 1.3$	$\bar{c} = 3.5$
			$N = 6,308$	$N = 5,899$
	Has images or links	$\bar{z} = 309$	$\bar{z} = 371$	$\bar{z} = 706$
		$\bar{c} = 7.0$	$\bar{c} = 8.6$	$\bar{c} = 10.1$
Not link post	No images or links	$N = 1,725$	$N = 8,917$	$N = 15,251$
			$\bar{z} = 280$	$\bar{z} = 1,303$
	Has images or links		$\bar{c} = 3.7$	$\bar{c} = 8.0$
			$N = 17,103$	$N = 23,532$

$\bar{z}$ is the average zaps received in the first 48 hours of posting; $\bar{c}$ is the average number of comments received in the first 48 hours; and N is the number of such posts.



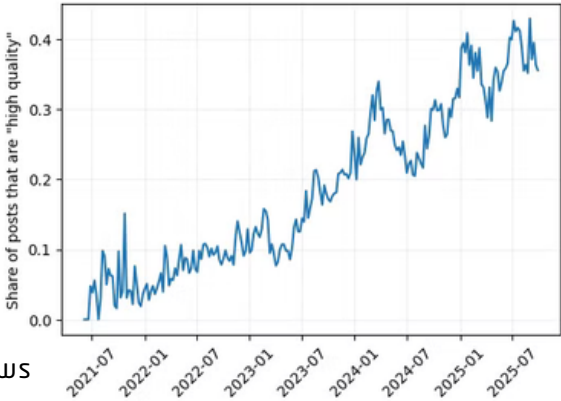
The table shows that:

- Link posts with no text are the most common type of post, but the least rewarded.
- Long-form discussion posts with images or links in the post body are the most rewarded.
- Link posts are less zapped and less commented on in general compared to discussion posts.
- Images or links in the post body seem to enhance longer posts, but do not necessarily enhance shorter posts.

One of the main questions of the research project is whether SN's incentives lead to higher quality content. Let's define a "high quality" post as a post that is either:

- >50 words discussion post
- >50 words link post with images or links in the post body. (Images or links in the post body of a link post suggest that the post content isn't just a copy/paste of the link itself. Also less likely to be AI generated.)

The graph below shows that the proportion of high quality posts is growing quite linearly over time on SN.



So, the dynamics on Stacker News indeed seem to be incentivizing the types of posts that attract more zaps and engagement. That seems like a good thing! Some people worry about the growth of users on SN, which has indeed been slow, but the quality of the discussion and engagement seems to have been going up over time.

1. This is a series of public research journals for an academic research project using Stacker News data. Please see [#1243188](#) and [#1269944](#) for more details.

top post



Yes, Bitcoin Treasury Companies are Scams (Money Stuff, Matt Levine)



Bloomberg
.com

1098 sats \ 12 comments \ @denillaapan 9 Dec econ

At least on par with NFT craze.

DATs

I write occasionally, even now, about the circa-2021 craze for nonfungible tokens, and every time I do I worry that no one will believe me. "Wait people bought paintings, burned them to ashes, and then sold a digital pointer to a video of the ashes for more than the painting was worth? What? Why?" And I'll have to be like "I'm not saying it made any sense, it was nuts even at the time, I'm just saying it happened." I barely believe it myself.

By 2027 I will occasionally mention digital asset treasury companies, and there will be the same shock of disbelief. "Wait, people would put \$100 million of Bitcoin in a pot and sell shares of the pot for \$200 million? What? Why would anyone buy that?" And I'll have to be like "yeah no I hear you, it was nuts even at the time, I'm just saying it happened."

- < *An array of public companies thought they had found a sort of perpetual motion machine: Use your corporate cash to buy up Bitcoin or other digital tokens and presto, your share price shot up even more than the value of the tokens you bought. it **was always hard to explain why tokens should be worth more just because they were held by a public company**, and the wheels began to come off the car, at first slowly and then much more quickly.*

Pathetic. We don't need this crap in Bitcoin...
please, dudez, sell your coins and leave.

...

top post



A bunch of alarming shit

2850 sats \ 42 comments \ @elvismercury
11 Dec BooksAndArticles



Substack

(Actual article title: *The 26 Most Important Ideas For 2026*)

Lots of interesting things in this, too many to linger on.
Here's just one:

< *A systematic review of 71 studies with 98,000 participants published in 2025 reached an alarming finding. Across the dozens of studies, heavy short-form video users showed moderate deficits in attention, inhibitory control, and memory. In the chart below, you can see a consistently negative, if also heterogeneous, relationship between heavy short-form video use and problems with attention, memory, and control.*

...

< *But taken together, [the studies] suggest a plausible mechanism: a daily diet of hyper-rewarding, rapid-fire stimuli may gradually reshape attention and regulatory systems in ways that weaken our attentional control.*

This hypothesis is, neuroscientifically speaking, extremely plausible. One can (and ought to) look at the routines of daily life as a kind of training. The natural question that arises is: what are you

training yourself for? The idea that most of the industrialized world is training themselves in the manner described above is consistent with my experience and also horrifying.

Anyway, lots of thought-provoking things. Relevant to
 [this recent post](#)
about reading, too.

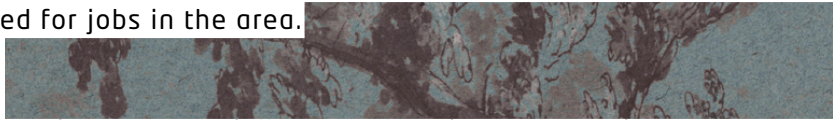




10k sats \ 29 comments \ @jasonb 11 Dec bitcoin

Starry-Eyed

Ever since this post ([#1243668](#)), I've had a lot of folks here curious how things have developed[1]. For those joining, I moved my family to South Africa for a few months this past season to volunteer at Bitcoin Ekasi, see if we had what it takes to live overseas, and hopefully teach locals what I've learned about coupling home automation with bitcoin mining. The last of these goals was inspired by the massive amount of private solar power in the region coupled with the bitcoin adoption and need for jobs in the area.



I've written tangentially about how it was becoming apparent that I failed in this last goal, and I hope to flesh that out here, along with what I learned, now that I have at least one month of semi-productive data. I'd like to share some good news first though, as I know at least a couple of you are curious about the first two stated goals. If you'd rather skip to the home solar mining stuff, [click here](#), but be forewarned that I'm primary writing this as an open letter to myself and my family to process this past season.

Bitcoin Ekasi

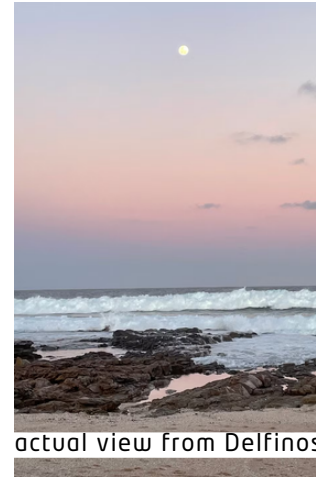
What's happening in the region is really exciting. People are using bitcoin for everything. There is not a single human need that you can't pay for in bitcoin in that community.

I was able to buy food, clothing, and shelter and as well as many superfluous goods and services entirely with bitcoin.



Here's the very first grocery run I ever paid for in bitcoin.

This is nice for me, as someone who doesn't want to hold US war tokens, but you can imagine how amazing it is for someone who's alternative is the South African rand.



actual view from Delfinos!

I've written a few other posts about how I tried to contribute, but I'll just share my absolute favorite anecdote here. Delfinos is this amazing restaurant on this beautiful beach. They didn't take bitcoin when we were there [2], but between the view, the food, and the playground/tidepool, it was hard to stay away.

I developed a relationship with a server from Zimbabwe. As one might imagine, it didn't take much to convince him to accept tips in bitcoin. We've been following up and now his sister, after years of trying to find a better

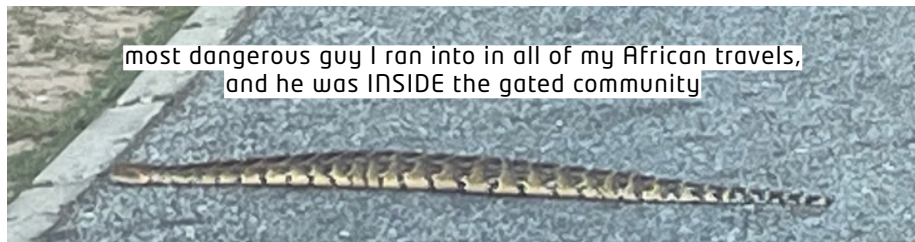
alternative to the traditional financial system, is able to quickly, safely, and affordably send money home to the family from Florida. This is why we bitcoin, right!? It was an immense privilege to be a small part of their family's story.

A Midwest Family in Africa

My wife reminds me when I get sad about how little I accomplished that our primary goal was to see if we could live there with kids from a safety and community standpoint. The short answer is yes!

The poverty is horrifying. While I'd never recommend going somewhere just to check out the poverty, I'd also be quick to add that shielding yourself from poverty doesn't do anything to help folks trapped by it. What I learned is that poverty doesn't always equate to violence, although I'm still a little baffled by this. I spent on average five days a week most of my daytime hours in the township. We started out spending our nights in a gated community but moved into the central part of the town as quick as we could. The gated community was a mistake, influenced by fear-mongering from a number of different sources. While I've heard things are worse in other parts of the country, I can genuinely say that the Western Cape feels about as safe as anywhere I've ever lived, and significantly safer than many neighborhoods way more affluent that I've lived in the USA. In Mossel Bay, you really do need to be looking for trouble in order to find it.

- continued -



As far as community, we made lots of different friends from a number of different communities. Despite the radical difference in wealth and lifestyle, people were very accepting. I like to think that's because things are changing due to opportunities that the bitcoin adoption allows, but I don't really know for sure. Either way, the whole region is very warm and there's an old-school love of conversation and debate that was a big breath of fresh air for me. We missed a lot of the cultural elements of home, but there's nothing like being around people who still know how to be personable with strangers.

If we did it again, I'd work harder to get the kids into programs where they'd be around more peers. I'm also concerned how all of this is affecting their long-term friendships.

So, could we live there forever? I'm not sure. Would we go back for a time? In a heartbeat!

The Best Laid Plans

In Spades

I was right about one thing.
Solar is everywhere!



People **really** want to find something to do with that excess power too. I was

shocked how easily people were on board. I had written a pamphlet to give to solar installers and the first one I met wanted to get to business before even reading it!

The Machines Just Aren't There

I had reached out to a couple of industrial bitcoin miners before coming and explained the plan. I didn't receive a response from most and got timelines that didn't match my schedule from a couple of others. One actively discouraged the plan, arguing that home solar mining just can't be profitable. Once on the ground, I kind of assumed I'd be able to find at least a few by word of mouth or Craigslist type listings. This was not the case. I met a few other industrial miners, but they also derided the idea of home solar mining.

A point of consternation for me was seeing the way a couple of these industrial miners also actively promoted low-hashrate machines that cost **more** money than the recycled machines that I wanted to buy. Most of these lower hashrate machines are more efficient, but will still never return a ROI in any amount of time and are actually harvested from the machines that I wanted to use.

Braiins decided to donate an s9 to Bitcoin Ekasi, but it wasn't going to arrive until my final weeks. Closing in on the last month, I found a shit-coiner who had some s19s. They were significantly cheaper than anything I had seen advertised in South Africa, but still way more than what you'd pay for stateside. At this point, I wanted to run anything just to show the concept works, but I knew I'd only have a couple of weeks before I'd be gone. It seemed foolish to invest any more at that point.

I passed the distributor's contact info to two home solar users. While I sadly didn't have time to get to come alongside these guys to help install and set up automations, they were both perfectly happy to solar mine on their own terms. One bought an Avalon Q and just mines unprofitably because he believes in the mission. The other claims he has a massive bank of batteries and can mine off his solar charge all night long. I don't know how that's going for him at this point, but I felt like I did my due diligence explaining what I knew to him.

The Braiins Donation

So I waited for the s9 to come from Europe and put it in somebody's basement. We setup the quickest, dirtiest home automation and only mine when his solar battery is over 95% charged. He agreed to give me access to his Braiins pool account and donates a small portion of the earning to Bitcoin Ekasi. That said, it's an s9...

Anyway, that was one month ago today.

- continued -

Meme Monday - Best Bitcoin Meme Gets 5,000 CCs

666 sats \ 22 comments \ @sn
8 Dec memes



meme

winner

5065 sats \ 0 replies \ @0xbtcminer 8 Dec

just sold 1 bitcoin



Looking at the data from Braiins, it looks like he's mined about 127 sats a day at 3Th/s. So his average hash value has been 42.33, which is similar to what Luxor says to have expected in this time frame. It also means that if he had done the same thing with an s19, we could expect 846 sats a day. The solar installer that I spoke with the most down there thinks that we could have been significantly more liberal than 95% without messing up his power too.

But even at 846 sats a day, I think we'd be in business for anyone with a relative low-time preference perspective. The most skeptical industrial miner I encountered claimed that he could get s19s in South Africa for R7000[3], which today is 463,056 sats. That means, at this pretty conservative schedule, the miner would still be paid off and profitable in a year and a half. That's not to mention all of the benefits this adds for securing the bitcoin network, and therefor protecting the user's savings.

Maybe This Just Isn't My Battle

So I have one case study. I feel melancholy about the whole thing but hope that something comes of it for someone, even if I don't get to be involved in the next stage. I was excited to hear that Gridless is doing something like this in Zambia. It looks a little more complicated to me, but it also looks more efficient. My inspiration partly came from what they're normal model is. I just wanted to bring it all the way down to the personal level for decentralization purposes. It's very cool hearing Erik Hersman talking about these type of ideas as a "scattered" approach.



It also looks like Braiins is developing bespoke technology to these ends.

I still get very excited when I think about the potential to effect change in the townships by implementing these concepts domestically. Maybe one day an opportunity to educate and equip young people will manifest in a manner I never imagined.

Just A Little Bit Different

A few days after we got home, I got the call for my first gig in months. It would be that night at a restaurant I've played a thousand times. Nothing glamorous, just a simple restaurant gig. It would also be on the night of a community tree lighting. Everything felt surreal. I'd never gone so long in my life without playing music. It's been my primary source of income for over 20 years, and one that's typically seen as a privilege to do. It brought me to crazy places all over North American and Europe. I was happy to share stories and make music with old friends... But I feel like there are bigger fish to fry now.

< see post for footnotes and comments >